Lab 2.3 - Email the Report to the Manager

App: Microsoft 365 Copilot in **Outlook**

Purpose: Send each inspection report to the maintenance manager and request approval to close the work order.

Output: Two emails drafted with Copilot and checked by you, plus an `Approval_Log` in your register recording what was sent, to whom and when.

Work in `Work-Order-Register.xlsx` — the file you have carried since Lab 2.1. This folder's `Starter.xlsx` supplies the approval log and the recipient list as ready-made Excel tables; you copy its sheets across. The `.csv` files are a plain-text copy for the optional practice in Appendix A only.

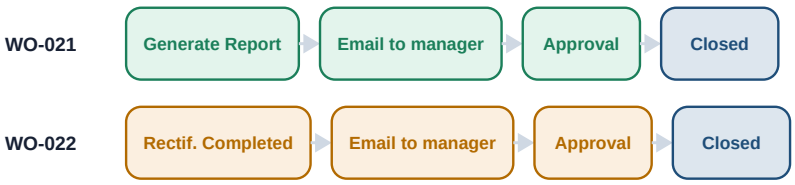
Where this sits in Module 2

Lab	App	What you produce
2.1	Excel	The work order register
2.2	Word	The two inspection reports
2.3	**Outlook**	**The approval request to the manager**
2.4	PowerPoint	The weekly update to the supervisor

The scenario

Both roadside inspections are written up. DR-17 on Jalan Besar passed at 32 mm. DR-23 on Clementi Avenue 2 failed at 74 mm, was desilted, and passed reinspection at 28 mm.

A report on your own laptop closes nothing. In the workflow you have been following, **Approval** is a real gate between Generate Report and Closed, and somebody with authority has to pass through it. In Labs 2.1 and 2.2 that approval was a mock entry in a log. Here you actually request it.



The two emails are not the same. One reports a straightforward pass. The other has to carry a failure, a rectification and a reinspection without letting the good news erase the bad.

Two files, and which is which

File	What it is
`Work-Order-Register.xlsx`	**Your own working file**, carried from Labs 2.1 and 2.2. You add the approval log to it here.
`Starter.xlsx`	**This lab's supplied data.** You open it to copy sheets out, then close it without saving.

Files in this folder

File	Use
`Lab-Instructions.pdf`	This activity and every copy-ready Copilot prompt.
`Starter.xlsx`	This lab's supplied data: the `ApprovalLog` and `Recipients` tables and the pre-send checklist.
`recipients.csv`	The recipient list as plain CSV. Not needed — Appendix A only.
`approval-log.csv`	The empty approval log as plain CSV. Not needed — Appendix A only.

Before you start: the sending rule

You are about to send real email from a real mailbox. Two rules, and they are not negotiable.

- **Send only to the training addresses** on the `Recipients` sheet, or to an address your trainer gives you. Never to a colleague, a manager or a supplier, even as a test. These reports describe a fictional road asset, and a real recipient has no way to know that.
- **Read the whole draft before you send it.** Copilot writes the email; you are the one sending it. Once sent, you cannot recall what the recipient has already read.

Step 1 - Reopen your register and bring in this lab's sheets

1. Open `Work-Order-Register.xlsx` — the register from Labs 2.1 and 2.2. This is where you work.
2. Open this folder's `Starter.xlsx` as well:

Sheet	What it holds
`Start_Here`	Where to begin, and what each sheet is for.
`Approval_Log`	The named table `ApprovalLog`, one row per approval request, with amber columns for you to fill.
`Recipients`	Who receives which report and what you are asking them to do.
`Before_You_Send`	Eight checks to run before pressing Send.
`Copilot_Prompt`	The same prompts printed here, ready to copy inside Excel.

3. Copy the `Approval_Log`, `Recipients` and `Before_You_Send` sheets into your register with

Move or Copy, as you did in Lab 2.2.

4. Close `Starter.xlsx` without saving. From here on you work only in `Work-Order-Register.xlsx`.
5. Check you still have `RPT-021.docx` and `RPT-022-v2.docx` from Lab 2.2. You attach them here.

Step 2 - Read the recipient list

On the `Recipients` sheet, note who gets what:

Role	Receives	What you are asking
Maintenance Manager	Both reports, for approval	Approve or return the report
Drainage Supervisor	Copy, for scheduling	Note the rectification outcome
Records Inbox	Copy, for filing	File it; no reply expected

Only the manager is being asked to decide. The other two are being kept informed — a distinction worth making explicit in the email, so nobody assumes somebody else is approving.

Step 3 - Draft the WO-021 email (the pass)

1. In Outlook, start a **New mail**.
2. Attach `RPT-021.docx`.
3. Open **Copilot** in the message window — look for **Draft with Copilot** under the message body.
4. Paste the first prompt below.
5. Read what comes back before you touch the recipient field.

Copy this prompt (email 1 of 2):

```
Draft an email to the maintenance manager requesting approval to close work
order WO-021.

Use only the attached inspection report RPT-021 and the work order register.

State plainly: the asset DR-17 on Jalan Besar; the inspection date; the
measured 32 mm against the 50 mm specification maximum; that it passed
on the first visit; and the evidence ID EV-021-1.

Keep it under 150 words. Use a subject line in the form
WO-021 DR-17 inspection passed - approval to close requested.
End with a clear request for the manager to approve or return the report.

Do not state that the work order is approved or closed. Do not invent a
deadline, a cost, a photograph or a signature. Attach nothing you were not
given.
```

Step 4 - Draft the WO-022 email (the rectified failure)

This is the harder of the two. The order failed, was rectified and passed on reinspection, and the email has to carry all three without misleading the reader.

1. Start another **New mail**. Do not reply to or forward the first one.
2. Attach `RPT-022-v2.docx` — the versioned report, not the original `RPT-022.docx`.
3. Open **Copilot** and paste the second prompt below.

Copy this prompt (email 2 of 2):

```
Draft an email to the maintenance manager requesting approval to close work
order WO-022.

Use only the attached report RPT-022-v2 and the work order register.

State plainly and in order: the asset DR-23 on Clementi Avenue 2; the initial
reading of 74 mm against the 50 mm maximum, which failed; the
rectification recorded in the log; the reinspection reading of 28 mm,
which passed; and the evidence IDs EV-022-1 and EV-022-2.

The initial failure must remain visible in the email, not be replaced by the
passing result. Keep it under 200 words. Use a subject line in the form
WO-022 DR-23 rectified and reinspected - approval to close requested.

Do not claim the root cause is proven. Do not state that the work order is
approved or closed. Do not invent a deadline, a cost, a photograph or a
signature.
```

Step 5 - Check both drafts against the source

Copilot writes fluently, which is exactly why this step matters. A confident sentence is not a checked one. Work through the `Before_You_Send` sheet:

#	Check
1	Every figure in the email matches the report and the register.
2	The WO-022 email still shows the 74 mm failure, not only the 28 mm pass.
3	Nothing claims the work order is already approved or closed.
4	No root cause is asserted for the WO-022 failure.
5	No invented deadline, cost, photograph or signature.
6	The recipient is the training address, never a real colleague.
7	The correct report version is attached: RPT-021, and RPT-022-v2 not v1.
8	You have read the whole draft yourself.

The most likely failure is **check 2**. Asked to summarise, a language model tends toward the tidy ending — "DR-23 was inspected and meets the specification" is true of the second visit and hides the first. If the manager cannot see that the post failed, they cannot judge whether the rectification was adequate. Fix that in the draft yourself; do not ask Copilot to try again and hope.

Step 6 - Send, and record what you sent

1. Put the manager's training address in **To**, and the supervisor and records addresses in **Cc**.

2. Send both emails.
3. In your register's `Approval_Log`, fill in for each row: `Sent_SGT` with the send time, `Recipient`, and a `Review_Note` recording anything you corrected in Copilot's draft.
4. Leave `Approval_Status`, `Approved_By` and `Approved_SGT` **blank**. You have requested approval; you have not received it. Recording an approval that has not happened is the exact failure this lab exists to prevent.

Step 7 - Summarise any reply

If your trainer sends a reply, or a classmate replies as the manager:

1. Open the reply in Outlook and open **Copilot**.
2. Paste the prompt below.
3. Record the outcome in `Approval_Log`, using the manager's own wording for the decision.

Copy this prompt:

```
Summarise this email thread for the work order register.

Return only: who replied, the date and time, whether the reply is an approval,
a rejection, or a request for more information, and any condition the manager
attached.

Quote the manager's decision wording exactly. If the reply does not clearly
approve or reject, say NOT A CLEAR DECISION and state what is missing.
Do not infer approval from a polite acknowledgement.
```

Only when a reply clearly approves may you set `Approval_Status` to Approved and record who approved it and when. A "thanks, received" is not an approval.

Step 8 - Save your work

Now save your work.

1. In Excel, press **Ctrl+S** (**Cmd+S** on Mac) to save `Work-Order-Register.xlsx`. It should now hold the Lab 2.1 sheets, the Lab 2.2 inspection sheets, and this lab's `Approval_Log`.
2. Keep both sent emails in your Sent Items. Lab 2.4 reports on this week's work and refers to them.

Pass conditions

- Both emails were drafted with Copilot and read in full before sending.
- The WO-022 email shows the failure, the rectification and the reinspection, in that order.
- Neither email claims approval, closure or a proven root cause.
- Every figure traces to the report and the register.
- `Approval_Log` records what was sent and when, and leaves approval blank until a reply grants it.

• Nothing was sent to a real colleague or an address outside the training tenant.

Appendix A - Optional: import the CSVs yourself

You do not need this if you are using `Starter.xlsx`. Use it only for the import practice, or if the starter file is unavailable.

1. Open your `Work-Order-Register.xlsx`.
2. **Data** tab -> **Get Data** -> **From File** -> **From Text/CSV**.
3. Select `approval-log.csv`, choose **Import**, check the comma delimiter, then

Load To... -> **Table** -> **New worksheet** -> **OK**.

4. Click inside the new table. On **Table Design**, set **Table Name** to `ApprovalLog`.

Rename the sheet tab to `Approval_Log`.

5. Repeat for `recipients.csv`, naming that table `Recipients` on a sheet named `Recipients`.
6. Save as **Excel Workbook (*.xlsx)**, keeping the Lab 2.1 and 2.2 sheets.

All records in this lab are fictional training data. The recipient addresses are fictional training addresses, not real mailboxes. They describe no actual facility, person or organisation. Values are teaching assumptions, not approved design criteria. Do not use any output to operate, maintain or approve real equipment, and do not send any of it to a real recipient.